Interface & UX ReDesign

Kochi 1 Redesign

Malavika P Pillai





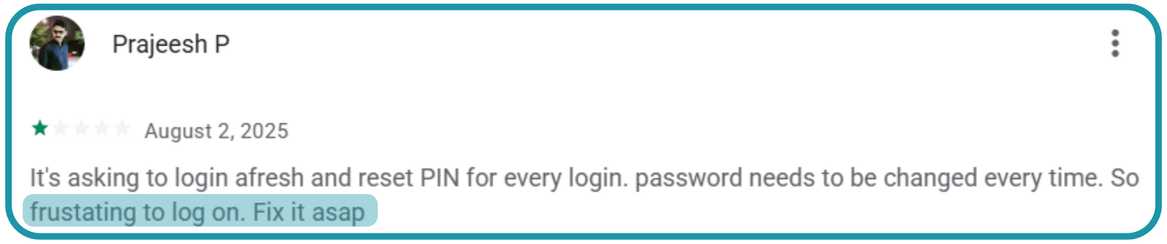
Kochi1 is an **all-in-one mobility and payment app** developed by KMRL and Axis Bank, designed to simplify everyday travel across Kochi. Users can **book metro tickets, plan journeys, check transit information, and manage their Kochi1 Card** from a single platform.

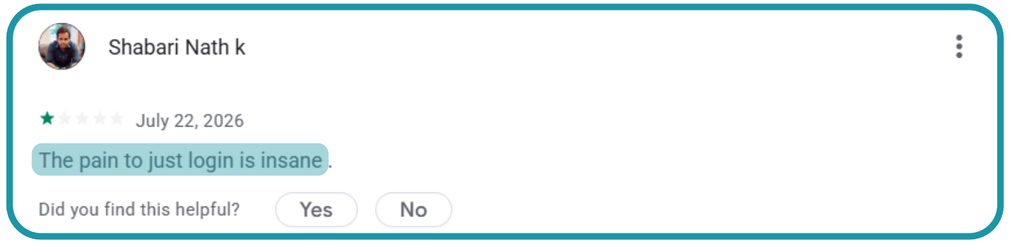
The app also brings together **card recharge, balance management, QR ticketing, routes, fares, and nearby transit information,** making it a central digital platform for Kochi’s public transport experience.

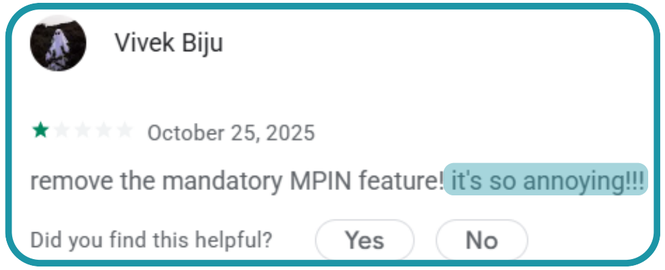
Why Kochi 1?

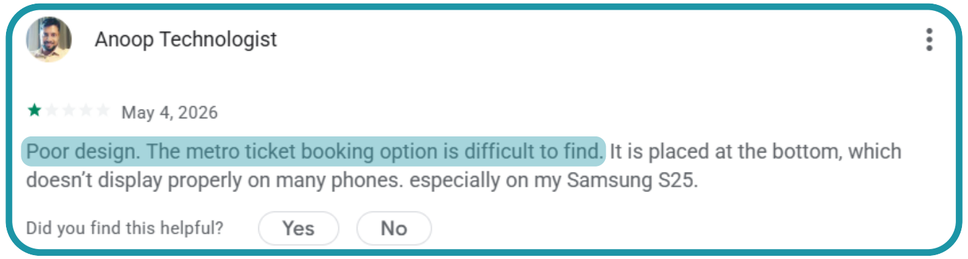
A product with strong potential, but a disconnected user experience.
Kochi1 brings **transit, payments and everyday mobility** into one ecosystem.
But our research revealed a gap between what the app offers and how easily people can use it.
68% knew about the app
29% had actually used it
This made Kochi1 an opportunity to explore how **better navigation, clarity and trust** could make an existing public-service product easier to use.

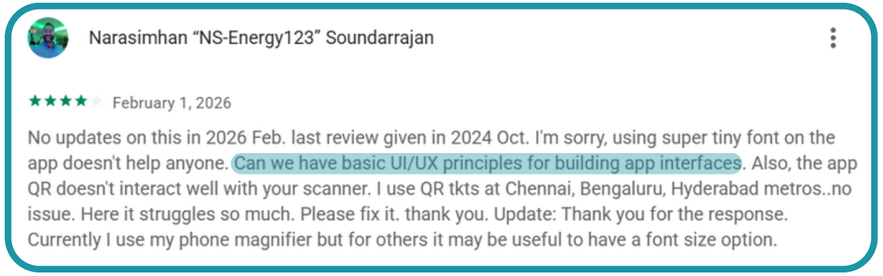




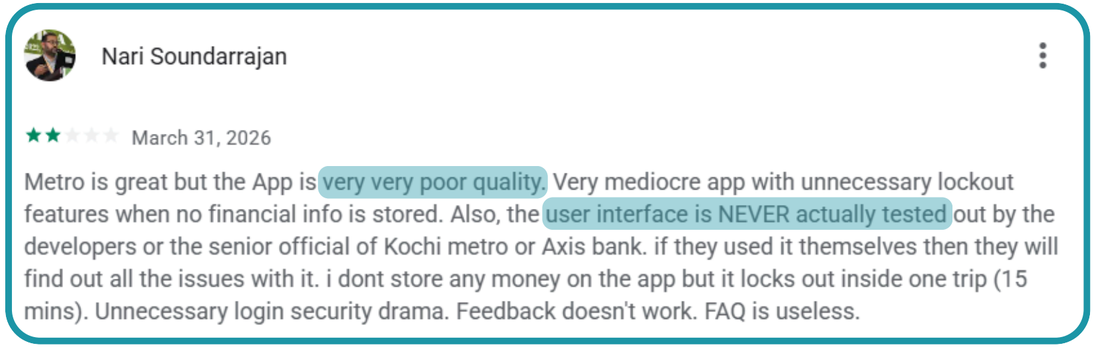


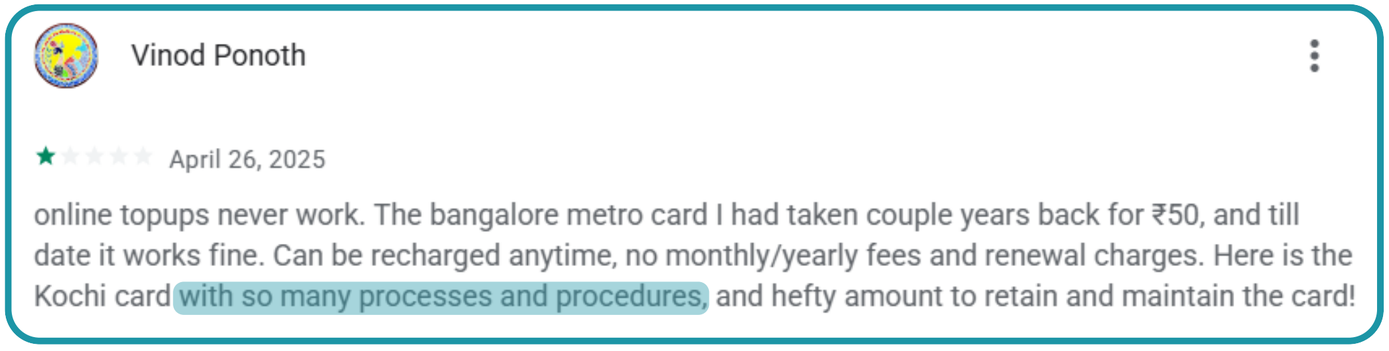


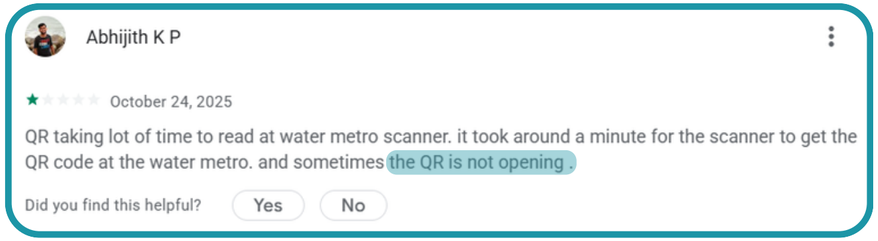


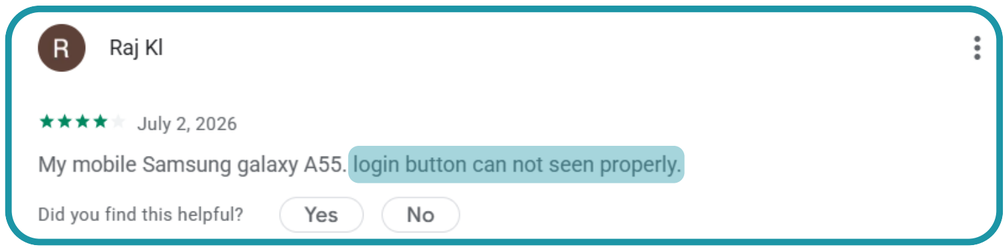


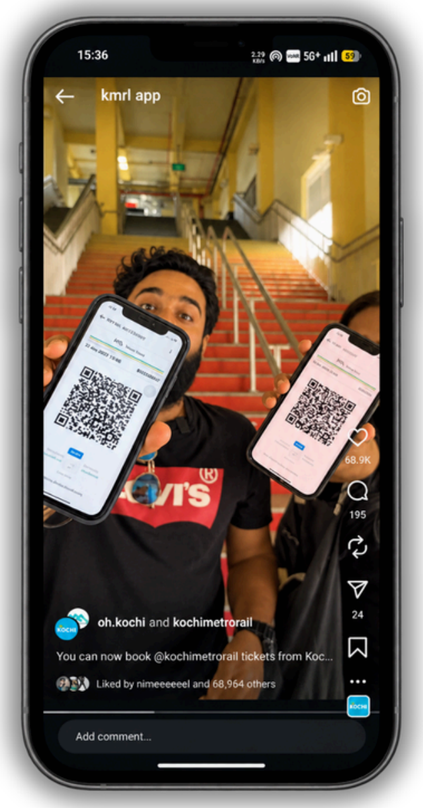
despite being an established platform for kochi1 users, the app still falls short in everyday use. recent app store reviews reveal recurring frustrations, usability issues, and gaps in the experience.











silpa.s_s 188w
ഒരു തവണ ഒറ്റ തവണയേ കാലിൽ turnstile ഇടിച്ചിട്ടുള്ളു, പിന്നെ അത്
ഓർക്കുക്കുമ്പോഴേ പേടിയാ, അതോടു കൂടി ഒറ്റക്കുള്ള metro യാത്ര മതിയാക്കി..!!
😑
Reply See translation

"Got stuck at the turnstile once and ended up giving up on travelling alone by Metro."

wander__1ust 190w
ഇത്രയും irritated ആയിട്ട് ഒരു app ഡെയിലി യൂസ് ചെയ്തിട്ടില്ല.. ട്രെയിൻ മിക്ക ടൈമിൽ മിസ്സ് ആക്കും.. ആൾക്കാരുടെ ദേഷ്യവും മേടിച് തരും.. ഇത്രയും കോടിയുടെ infrastructure ഉള്ള കമ്പനിക് നല്ലൊരു ആപ് ചെയ്യാൻ പാടിലെ..
Reply See translation
4

"I've never been this irritated by an app. For a company with such good infrastructure, they should have made a better app."

__iam__nikhil__ 191w
ഞാൻ ബുക്ക് ചെയ്തു but scan ആവുന്നില്ല അവസാനം cancel ചെയ്തു ടിക്കറ്റ് എടുത്തു 😔
Reply See translation

"I booked the ticket, but it wouldn't scan, so I had to cancel the ticket."

vishnutc_2.0 191w
Oru thavana use cheythu, exit chadi kadakkendi vannu
Reply See translation

sneha_mariaa 191w
Useless app..
Reply

tulip_tail 191w
Aa app kollulaa
Reply

__as_win__kukku_ 191w
Koppee annee keran pati irangi patiyilaa
Reply See translation
View 1 more reply

illuminandii 191w
Puthiya app onnumalla kure aayi. Edakku work aavum, edakku aavilla. Scanning glitches, payment kainju ticket kittathirikkuka. Issues station staffnodu chodichappol avarkum no idea. Cheriya glitches ennu paranjittu enthu karyam, basic functions work aayillel pinnenthu app.
Reply See translation

"The app has frequent glitches, scanning and ticket issues make even basic functions unreliable."

thesexy_drummer 191w
Honestly this app sucks, oru pravisham book cheytal pinne orikalum book cheyella, it needs a lot of big fixes and stabilization. Right now it's really bad, hope it gets better soon cos it'll be very helpful
Reply
2

larunraja 191w
ആപ്പ് വഴി ടിക്കറ്റ് എടുത്ത് സ്കാൻ ചെയ്യാൻ നോക്കിയിട്ട് സ്കാൻ ആയില്ല. അവസാനം കൗണ്ടറിൽ നിന്ന ആള് വന്നു പഠിച്ച പണി പതിനെട്ടും പയറ്റിയിട്ട് ഒന്നും നടന്നില്ല. പിന്നെ കൗണ്ടറിൽ നിന്ന് പകരം ടിക്കറ്റ് എടുത്ത് തരേണ്ടി വന്നു. 🙏🙏🙏
Reply See translation
3

"The ticket wouldn't scan, so I eventually had to get one from the counter."

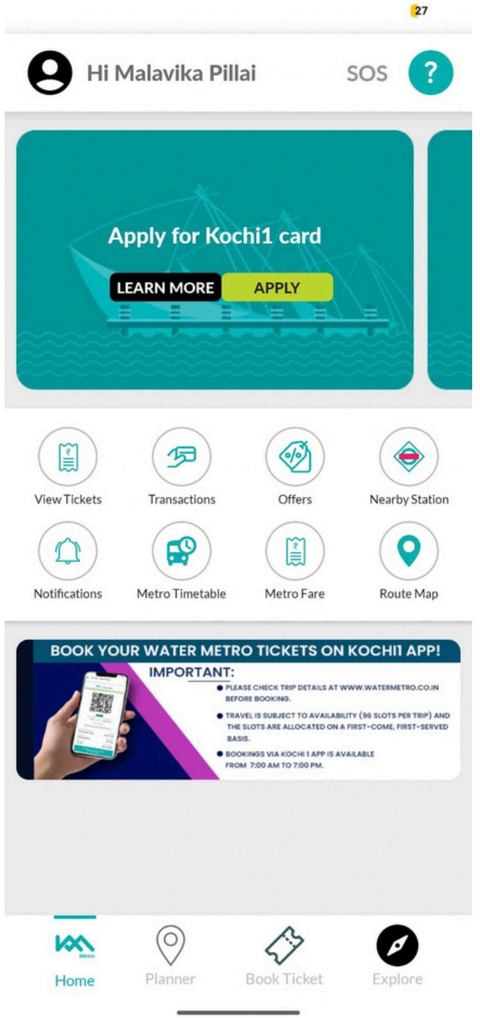
Competitor Analysis

App	Core Strength	Where It Works Well	Where It Fails
	Multimodal mobility	One journey across bus, metro & rail	Complex ecosystem
	Unified transit ticketing	Map-based multimodal planning	Many operators increase complexity
	Detailed metro information	Routes, fares, stations & facilities	Broad feature set
	Fast metro ticketing`	QR tickets + card recharge	Limited multimodal scope

Heuristics

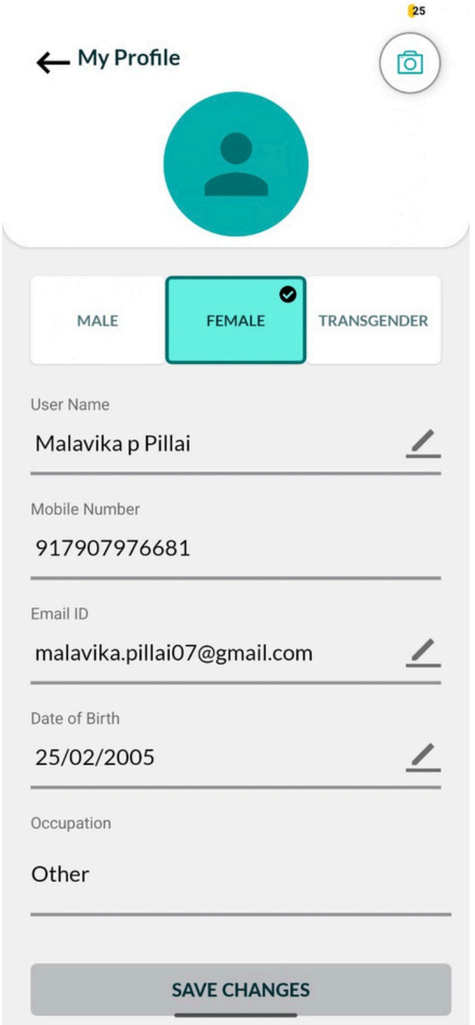
- **Visibility of system status:**
  After editing profile information and pressing “Save Changes,” there is no visible confirmation such as “Changes saved” or a success state.
  Why it matters:
  The user is left unsure whether the update was actually completed.

- **Match between system and real world:**
  From the homepage, Offers suggests that the user will see available offers. Instead, it opens a collection of categories such as tourist places, restaurants, malls, ATMs, hospitals, fuel, and parks, with Offers appearing again as another category.
  Why it matters:
  The label and the resulting content do not match the user's expectation.



- **Consistency and standards:**
  The user selects Offers, reaches a screen containing another Offers option, and has to select it again.
  Why it matters:
  It creates unnecessary navigation and makes the information hierarchy unclear.

- **Visibility of system status:**
  After going through two “Offers” entry points, the user reaches “No offers available.”
  This is slightly different from the first problem. The issue isn't necessarily that there are no offers. The UI problem is that the journey gives the user no useful context or alternative action after reaching an empty state.



User Segment

Daily Commuters

- Use Kochi Metro frequently
- Travel regularly for college/work
- Often follow familiar routes
- Time-sensitive and convenience-driven
- Need quick access to routes, timings & tickets

Occasional Commuters

- Use Kochi Metro occasionally
- Travel for shopping, errands or leisure
- May be less familiar with routes & stations
- Need clear journey and ticket guidance
- Depend on the app when planning a trip

New Users

- Use Kochi Metro on unfamiliar routes
- May not know stations, connections or ticketing process
- Depend heavily on search & journey information
- Need clear guidance throughout the journey
- Look for confidence and reassurance while travelling

80+

Survey Responses

5+

User Interview

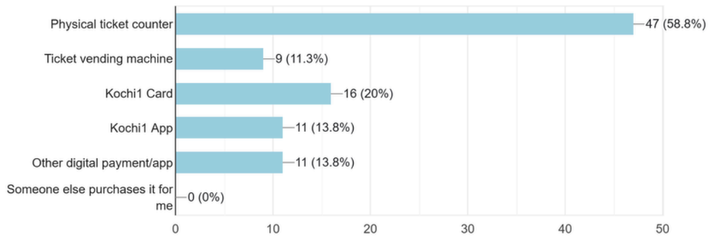
User Survey

Capturing real user experiences to uncover gaps in the current Kochi1 experience, with a focus on usability, navigation, information clarity, ticketing, and overall ease of use.



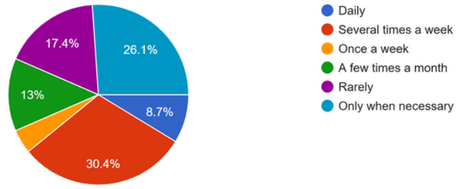
5. How do you usually purchase your metro ticket?

80 responses



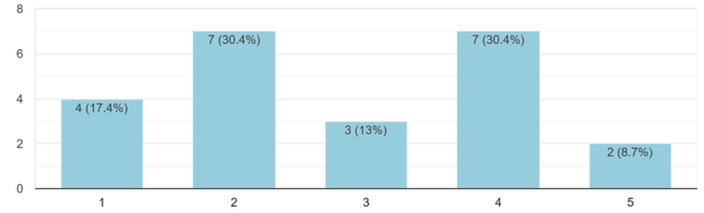
2. How often do you use the Kochi1 App?

23 responses



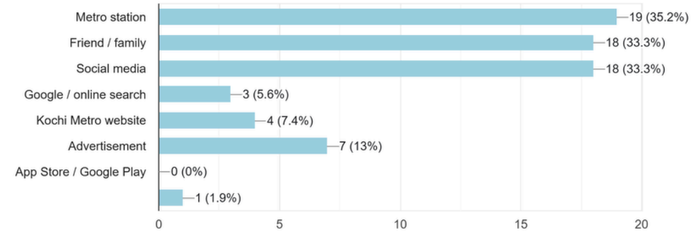
5. How easy is it to complete the task you came to the app for?

23 responses



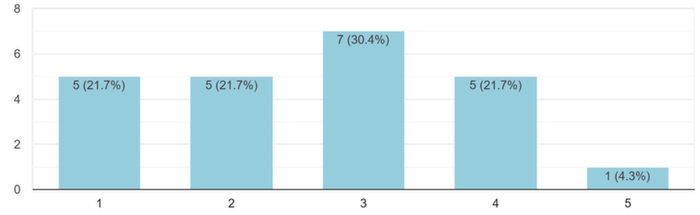
1. How did you first hear about the Kochi1 App?

54 responses



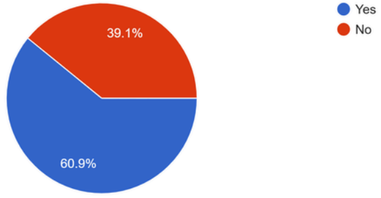
3. How easy is it to find what you need in the app?

23 responses



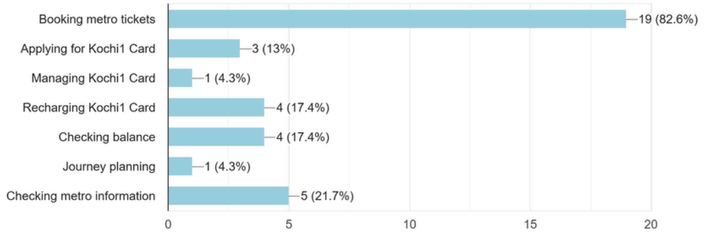
6. Have you ever been confused about what to do next while using the app?

23 responses



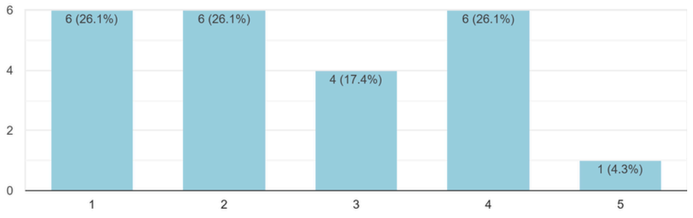
1. What have you used the Kochi1 App for?

23 responses



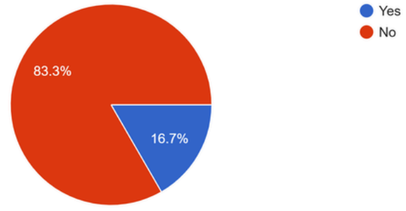
4. How easy is it to understand the information presented in the app?

23 responses



5. Were you able to complete the process without asking someone for help?

18 responses



3. What is one thing you would change about the Kochi1 App?

23 responses

information provided, also the wording could be better..journey section is confusing

N.A.

Don't know

Visual design

UI

Its visual design

Nothing

On multiple days, the QR code was not generated even after successful payment.

I would make the Kochi1 app simpler and more user-friendly, with clearer navigation and easier access to essential services like ticket booking, balance, and travel history.

3. What is one thing you would change about the Kochi1 App?

23 responses

MPIN feature could be improved

visuals

it took around 3 minutes for the scanner to get the QR code at the water metro. and sometimes the QR is not opening.

performance and design

information heirarchy

clearer feedback

Information clarity

NA

More friendly and easy

“Users don’t just want a better-looking Kochi1 app — they want an app that feels clear, reliable, and effortless to use.”

Findings

- High digital comfort ≠ good Kochi1 experience
- Awareness ≠ adoption
- Core tasks are buried in friction
- Uncertainty erodes user trust
- The Kochi1 Card's biggest differentiator is buried
- Users depend on others when the app fails



Scenario

Rahul is new to the city and is rushing to meet a friend by Metro. At the station, it’s rush hour and crowded. His Kochi1 QR ticket fails to scan at the entry gate, and as he retries, a queue builds behind him. He feels embarrassed and flustered, conscious of the people waiting. Once through, he checks his ticket for the platform number, hoping it will point him in the right direction, but it isn’t shown. He looks around at unfamiliar signs, growing anxious about heading to the wrong side. Staff are busy handling the crowd, so by the time he gets someone’s attention and learns the platform, the train has already left. He feels frustrated and helpless as he waits for the next one, knowing he will be late to meet his friend.

Outcome: Even with a valid ticket, the missing platform information costs Rahul time and adds stress. He leaves feeling less confident about relying on Kochi1 for a smooth journey.

Storyboard


Metro
Just have to scan and get in... I'm already late.
Oh no... let me try again.
Scan Failed
There's a whole queue behind me...
Scan Failed
Where's the platform number?
Kochi1
Valid Ticket
From
To
Exit
Platforms
Information
Platform 1
Platform 2
Which side is it? I don't even know where to go...
Next Metro in 8 mins
By the time I got someone's attention... the train already left.
Great.

Persona



Rahul Ajith

24, Male
PERSONAL

Kochi
LOCATION

Graduate Trainee
PROFESSION

Character Traits:

- Time-conscious and punctual
- Unfamiliar with the city
- Easily flustered in crowded situations

Goals:

- Reach destinations on time
- Navigate Metro stations confidently
- Use Kochi1 for a smooth, reliable journey

Pain Points:

- QR ticket fails to scan at entry gates
- Platform number is missing from the ticket
- Unfamiliar signs make navigation difficult
- Busy staff are hard to reach during rush hour

Says

- “My ticket is valid, so why isn’t it scanning?”
- “Which platform do I need to go to?”
- “I’m already getting late.”
- “There are so many people waiting behind me.”



Rahul Ajith

Thinks

- “Am I doing something wrong?”
- “What if I miss the train?”
- “Why isn’t the platform mentioned on my ticket?”
- “Who can help me in this crowd?”

Does

- Retries scanning the QR ticket at the gate.
- Checks the ticket for platform information.
- Looks around for signs and station staff.
- Waits for the next train after missing one.

Feel

- Embarrassed when the QR scan fails.
- Anxious about finding the right platform.
- Frustrated by the lack of clear information.
- Less confident about relying on Kochi1.

Scenario

Anu wants to check Water Metro timings and routes before leaving home, so she opens Kochi1, expecting it to take a minute. The Home screen is full of shortcuts and promotional banners, but nothing clearly shows which transport services the app offers or where to find each one. She scans the screen for a Water Metro or Travel Services option and feels mildly confused when she can’t spot one. Unsure where to look, she starts tapping through different sections, and her confusion turns into impatience as the quick check stretches out. By the time she finds the transport modes under Book Ticket in the bottom navigation, she feels frustrated that something so basic was so hard to find. She wonders what else the app offers that she hasn’t discovered, and begins to doubt whether Kochi1 is a dependable place to check public transport information.

Outcome: A quick pre-trip check turns into trial and error. Because the Home screen doesn’t present the app’s services in a clear structure, Anu leaves frustrated and less confident in Kochi1 as a reliable travel companion.

Storyboard


Let me check the Water Metro timings.
Kochi1*
Quick Links
Maybe this has the timings...
Book Water Metro Tickets
Wait... why is this not in the app?
www.
So it's under Book Ticket...
Book Ticket
Metro
Water Metro
Bus
Home
Planner
Book Ticket
Explore
Why was this so hard to find?



Anu Natan

26, Female
PERSONAL

Kochi
LOCATION

Marketing Executive
PROFESSION

Character Traits:

- Independent and practical
- Prefers quick, straightforward information
- Easily frustrated by confusing navigation

Goals:

- Check Water Metro routes and timings
- Find transport easily
- Travel confidently with Kochi1

Pain Points:

- Cluttered Home screen
- Hard-to-find transport services
- Confusing app navigation
- Slow access to basic information

Says

- “Where can I find Water Metro timings?”
- “Why is this so difficult to find?”
- “Which section should I check?”
- “I just wanted a quick look before leaving.”



Anu Natan

Thinks

- “Am I missing something obvious?”
- “Why aren't the transport services clearly organised?”
- “What else does this app offer?”
- “Can I rely on this app for travel information?”

Does

- Scans Home for transport options.
- Navigates through app sections.
- Searches for Water Metro and travel services.
- Finds transport modes under Book Ticket.

Feel

- Confused by the crowded Home screen.
- Impatient when information takes too long to find.
- Frustrated by unnecessary navigation.
- Unsure whether Kochi1 is reliable.

Scenario

Meera needs to travel from Fort Kochi to Edappally for an important appointment. She opens Kochi1 feeling hopeful that the app will make the journey simple. The navigation bar shows Planner and Book Tickets, and she feels a flicker of uncertainty about which one to start with, since Planner and Book Tickets seem to mean much the same thing. She chooses Planner, enters her start and destination, and waits for a clear plan. Instead, the results combine Water Metro, Metro and feeder bus in a cluttered layout. She feels overwhelmed as she tries to work out how the modes connect, where she needs to change, and how the route fits together. Comparing the options only makes it worse, and she feels her stress rising. With the appointment drawing closer, the stress turns into panic: what if she picks the wrong route, misses a connection or arrives late? She closes the app feeling anxious and unsure, no more confident than before she opened it.

Outcome: The Planner is one of the app's most useful features, but it doesn't make a complex multimodal trip feel simple. Meera ends up more stressed than reassured and doesn't trust Kochi1 to get her there on time.

Storyboard


Kochi1
Kochi1
Journey
Planner
Book Tickets
Planner
From
Fort Kochi
To
Edappally
Find Routes
Planner Results
1 hr 10 min
via Water Metro + Metro + Bus
1 hr 25 min
via Metro + Bus
1 hr 40 min
via Water Metro + Bus



Meera Ram

32, Female
PERSONAL

Kochi
LOCATION

Teacher
PROFESSION

Character Traits:

- Organised and responsible
- Time-conscious and cautious
- Easily overwhelmed by complex information

Goals:

- Reach destinations on time
- Plan multimodal journeys
- Find the best route easily

Pain Points:

- Confusing Planner and Book Tickets sections
- Cluttered route results
- Unclear transfers and connections
- Anxiety about wrong routes or missed connections

Says

- “Planner or Book Tickets?”
- “How do the modes connect?”
- “Which route is easiest?”
- “What if I miss a connection?”



Meera Ram

Thinks

- “Aren't Planner and Book Tickets supposed to be different?”
- “How do I know where to change?”
- “Which option is the most reliable?”
- “I don't have time to figure all this out.”

Does

- Opens Planner to enter her destination.
- Compares Metro, Water Metro and feeder bus options.
- Tries to understand route connections and transfers.
- Closes the app when the results feel overwhelming.

Feel

- Uncertain about which feature to use.
- Overwhelmed by cluttered route information.
- Stressed about missing connections.
- Anxious and less confident about her journey.

STRUCTURE & NAVIGATION

Information Architecture

Restructuring the Kochi1 transit ecosystem from a cluttered multi-menu layout into an intuitive multimodal journey hierarchy.

CURRENT STRUCTURE

Existing Information Architecture

Current multi-layer navigation with redundant menus, overlapping planner routes, and fragmented card balance services.

[Existing Information Architecture Diagram]

Clear demarcated area for current Kochi1 sitemap, navigation layers, and service taxonomy.

PROPOSED REDESIGN

Redesigned Information Architecture

Simplified hierarchy: unified multimodal ticketing, real-time timetable integration, and direct one-tap card management.

[Redesigned Information Architecture Diagram]

Clear demarcated area for streamlined IA, unified navigation bar, and primary user task paths.

INTERACTION & JOURNEYS

User Flows

Step-by-step task flows designed to eliminate friction across metro booking, multimodal transfers, and payment validation.

Key Task Flow Diagrams

Optimized decision trees mapped directly from commuter pain points identified during fieldwork research.

Flow 1: Quick QR Metro Ticket

Flow 2: Multimodal Route Planning

Flow 3: Card Recharge & Balance

[User Flow Diagrams]

Clearly marked empty area for comprehensive user flow diagrams, decision nodes, error recovery states, and screen transitions.

KMRL · KOCHI1 INTERFACE DESIGN

The screens are in the process of being designed.

Translating verified user insights, simplified information architecture, and core journey flows into refined, accessible high-fidelity interfaces for Kochi’s daily commuters.

Malavika P Pillai • Interface & UX ReDesign • Kochi Metro Rail Limited (KMRL)